DEFINITIONS OF FOREIGN POLICY

To put in simple terms, foreign policy is the output of the state into a global system. 'Policy' is generally considered as "a guide to an action or a set of actions intended to realize the goals of an organization that it has set for itself" which involves 'choice' or choosing actions (or making decisions) to achieve one's goal. 'Foreign' implies those territorially sovereign units that exist beyond the legal boundaries of a particular state. That is to say, anything beyond that legal territorial boundary, not under the legal authority of the state concerned, is foreign. Therefore, "foreign policy" is considered to be a set of guidelines to choices being made about people, places and things beyond the boundaries of the state concerned.[1]

Padelford and Lincoln[2] point out that foreign policy consists of courses of actions which a state generally undertakes to realize its national objectives beyond the limits of its own jurisdiction. They further contend that foreign policy of a state is "something more than a mere collection of several specific policies which it pursues with respect to individual countries". A state's foreign policy takes into account several factors such as an estimate of its own power and capabilities, the broad principles of conduct which the state holds and its government advocates with respect to international affairs, the specific objective of national interest which the state seeks for itself in foreign relations as well as for the course of world affairs generally. Foreign policy also involves the strategies and commitments and tactics which are undertaken for the realization of a state's objectives and interests.

There are others who have tried to give a definition of foreign policy. C.C. Rodee and others in *Introduction to Political Science* (1957) defines foreign policy as involving "the formulation and implementation of a group of principles which shape the behaviour of a state while negotiating with (contracting) other states to protect or further its vital interest". Professor Charles Burton Marshall (*The Exercise of Sovereignty*, 1965) defines foreign policy as "the course of action undertaken by authority of state and intended to affect